

AN OFFER LIKE NEVER BEFORE

Subscribe
Electronics For You
and Get
Electronics Yellow Pages
Winter + Coming Summer Edition
Absolutely Free!



Key features of Electronics Yellow Pages

Yellow Pages With Over 2,000 Products Categories More Than 7000 Organisation Listed Listing Of Important Electronics Associations Data Updated Periodically To Maintain Accuracy

	Electronics For You (Plain) Cover Price (₹) 600 Period 1 Year Issues 12 You Pay (₹) 600	Assured Gift: EYP Winter Edition (published in February 2012) Worth Rs 500 + EYP Summer Edition (to be published in July 2012) Worth Rs 500
--	--	---

Name _____
 Designation _____
 Organisation _____ Mailing Address _____
 City _____ Pin Code _____
 State _____ Phone _____
 Email _____
 Subscription No. (for existing subscribers only) _____

I would like to subscribe to the above magazine starting with the next issue.

Please find enclosed a sum of Rs _____ by DD/MQ/crossed cheque* bearing the No. _____ dt. _____ in favour of EFY

Enterprises Pvt Ltd, payable at Delhi. (*Please add Rs 50 on non-metro cheque).

To pay through credit card/debit card/net banking, please visit: www.pay.efyindia.com

Send this filled-in form or its photocopy to :

EFY EFY Enterprises Pvt Ltd D-571, DDA Industrial Area, Phase 1, New Delhi 110 029 India
 Tel: 011-26817363 e-mail: info@efyindia.com Website: www.efyindia.com

Terms: If these rates are applicable for new subscribers as well as renewed by existing subscribers, if the rates are valid for subscribers within India only, if Please allow 4-6 weeks for processing of your subscription, if Disputes, if any, are subject to exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only.

starting spot. Some of the tasks performed by an electronics engineer at Acronis are customisation, integration, and managing the interoperability of Open Source tools and codes," he adds.

Verma recommends online self-learning. "Those who want to learn about Open Source hardware can join Openhardware.org—an initiative to Open Source hardware. It consists of physical artefacts of technology designed and offered in the same manner as free and Open Source software. A candidate can also opt for renowned certifications such as CDAC—a course that takes six to nine months to complete. However, as candidates learn the subject, they must acquire a strong understanding of hardware and its working, digital electronics fundamentals, systems domain and operating systems. The skills we look for are a good understanding of computer architecture, knowledge of 'C' and Assembly languages, problem solving and debugging skills, and knowledge of microprocessors and microcontrollers. All semiconductor and real-time system development companies recruit Open Source electronics engineers," Verma shares.

Will open hardware rival open software in popularity?

An increasing number of start-ups and entrepreneurial initiatives are opting for Linux in embedded systems for handheld devices, network switches, etc. There is a lot of focus on low-power architecture these days, where electronics engineers can play a crucial role. In software, the demand for people experienced in Open Source has increased as organisations get a deep understanding and foundation of software.

When asked whether we will see a similar trend in electronics engineers who have worked on Open Source, Verma replied, "Yes, it is very true for electrical engineers who have a very good understanding of hardware. They can be very helpful in designing real-time systems, human-machine interfaces, data acquisition systems, point-of-sale devices, etc."

Krishna believes that some companies are trying the route of Open Source electronics to enable people to develop products, but have not reached the same level of popularity as is seen with software.

"Open Source electronics is still in a very nascent stage. The entire industry might have to wait for a few more years before it becomes a significant movement that leads to job creation in large numbers. One example I have closely observed is Texas Instruments which has deployed low-cost development boards based on its OMAP and Da Vinci product lines. They have also provided development kits with the boards to enable easy application development," he adds. ●

The author is business correspondent at EFY Bengaluru